

‘What if I only have \$500?’

The good news is there’s never been a better time to start investing — you have so many options! Thanks to micro-investing apps and low-cost brokerage platforms, you can start with as little as \$5 or \$10 these days. You don’t need thousands to dip your toe in. The most important thing is *starting*, no matter how small the amount. Remember, even Daddy Buffet started off with a few dollars.

‘What if I don’t know which investment to pick?’

This is where people often get stuck in analysis paralysis. The truth is you don’t have to become a financial expert to start. Using simple, diversified options like index funds or ETFs takes the guesswork out. It’s about spreading your money across many companies rather than betting on one.

‘How risky is this? Could I lose all my money?’

Investing always carries risk but losing *everything* is less likely when you stick to diversified investments over many decades. Markets go up and down, that’s normal, but the key is time. The longer your money stays invested, the more time it has to recover from any short-term drops. Risk can also be managed by how you diversify your money and by avoiding speculative choices and things that you don’t fully understand.

‘What happens if the market crashes after I invest?’

This is a common fear, especially with all the media hype when markets dip. Market downturns are a normal part of investing. The key is not to panic and pull your money out at the wrong time. While past performance cannot guarantee future success, history has shown that markets recover. Having a long-term view helps you ride out these bumps.

‘I’m scared I’ll do it wrong, should I wait until I know more?’

It’s completely valid to feel this way. But waiting for the ‘perfect’ time or to know everything can mean you never start. The best way to learn is often by doing. Start small, learn as you go, and remember, you can adjust along